

DAVID MARK BROWNE

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Professional Experience

Full-stack product engineer building production web applications with Next.js, React, TypeScript, Node.js and PostgreSQL. Currently Head of Development at Default Media Group, owning technical delivery from architecture and build through to deployment and iteration. Previously spent eight years in technology investment banking and finance, bringing commercial and product experience alongside hands-on engineering.

Default Media Group — *Technology, Media & Digital Services Group*

Head of Development — London, UK

Aug 2026 – Present

- Lead engineering and technical direction across the group's digital products and client work.
- Own delivery from technical scoping and architecture through development, deployment and ongoing iteration.
- Translate commercial requirements into technical specifications, architecture decisions and delivery roadmaps.
- Own the production stack across **Next.js, React, TypeScript, Node.js, PostgreSQL, Sanity CMS and Vercel**.
- Partner with the founder on new business, assessing technical feasibility, defining scope and shaping delivery proposals.
- Develop AI-enabled product features and workflow automation using modern APIs and SDKs.

Senior Web Developer

May 2026 – Aug 2026

- Built and launched the company's new production website using **Next.js, React, TypeScript, Sanity CMS and Vercel**.
- Architected a headless CMS enabling non-technical users to manage services, team profiles, insights and site content.
- Built the frontend using **Next.js App Router, Server Components** and **ISR**, balancing content flexibility with performance and SEO.
- Owned deployment, domain migration and production configuration from development through launch.
- Optimised performance, accessibility and technical SEO, achieving Lighthouse scores of **96 Performance and 100 across Accessibility, Best Practices and SEO**.

Freelance — *Full-Stack Development*

Jun 2025 – Present

- Design and build web applications for private and third-sector clients using **Next.js, React, TypeScript, Node.js and PostgreSQL**.
- Build backend services and REST APIs with authentication, third-party integrations, caching and rate limiting.
- Design PostgreSQL schemas and application data models, integrating frontend, API and database layers.
- Deliver responsive production interfaces using **React and Tailwind CSS**, from initial requirements through deployment.

Technical Competencies

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), SQL, HTML, CSS

Frontend: React, Next.js, Tailwind CSS, shadcn/ui

Backend & Data: Node.js, Express, PostgreSQL, Supabase, Sanity CMS

APIs & Architecture: REST APIs, OAuth 2.0, Server Components, headless CMS, Vercel AI SDK

Tools: Git, GitHub, Vercel, Figma

Projects

[Portfolio Website](#) | [Next.js](#) · [TypeScript](#) · [Tailwind CSS](#) · [Sanity CMS](#)

[Staple](#) | [React](#) · [TypeScript](#) · [Node.js](#) · [Express](#) · [PostgreSQL](#) · [Supabase](#)

Full-stack PERN app emulating a “Wordle-style” guessing game for Magic: The Gathering

- Built a **PostgreSQL-backed backend** to serve daily challenges, manage card data and **persist player game state**
- Designed **RESTful API endpoints** for card retrieval, guess validation and daily challenge logic
- Implemented **cron-based automation** to select and rotate daily challenges without manual intervention
- Designed and deployed a responsive **Tailwind CSS** frontend across desktop and mobile
- Built the interactive game experience in **React and TypeScript**, including progressive clue reveals, guess tracking and win/loss states

[10 Songs](#) | [React](#) · [TypeScript](#) · [Spotify Web API](#) · [OAuth 2.0](#)

Interactive music game leveraging Spotify’s OAuth 2.0 authentication

- Built an interactive music game using Spotify data and authenticated user sessions.
- Implemented **OAuth 2.0/PKCE authentication**, token handling and API-driven gameplay.

Further Professional Experience

PCB Partners – *Technology-Focused Investment Bank*

Vice President — Technology M&A — London, UK

Oct 2022 – Mar 2025

- **Led buy-side** M&A execution for technology businesses backed by private equity and strategic investors.
- Contributed to technology transactions totalling **hundreds of millions in enterprise value**.
- **Worked directly with C-suite teams on acquisition strategy**, target evaluation and transaction execution across software and IT services.

Equiteq – *Technology-focused Investment Bank and M&A Strategy Consultant*

Associate (Corporate Finance) — London, UK

May 2017 – Feb 2022

- Advised technology and professional-services companies and private equity investors across 11 M&A transactions.
- Supported transactions including Hatch's acquisition of Brainwave and Intive's acquisition of Spark Digital.
- Helped grow the team through recruitment and mentoring of 10 colleagues.
- Conducted company analysis, valuation and investment thesis development across technology and professional-services markets.

Earlier experience: Research Analyst, HFIM (2017) — Hedge Funds; Analyst Intern, IlliquidX (2016–17) — Distressed Credit

Education & Additional

Bayes Business School (formerly Cass): MSc Finance — London, UK

Sep 2015 – Sep 2016

Royal Holloway, University of London: BSc (Hons) Geography & Geology, 2:1

Sep 2010 – Sep 2013

Certifications: Codecademy Full-Stack Developer

Completed 2026

Interests: Product development, investment analysis, cycling, football and technology; previously built and monetised an independent sports website and contributed articles reaching 10,000+ readers.

Languages: Italian (Intermediate)

Work authorisation: UK citizen — no sponsorship required